

04 Meals Food Entertainment Policy

India-focused synthetic enterprise reference policy | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 January 2026

PROVENANCE: This is a synthetic reference implementation created for RAG development. It is not an actual company policy. Production use requires replacement with the adopting company's approved policy, limits, grades and approval matrix.

1. Scope, Purpose & Definitions

Purpose

This policy establishes a controlled framework for authorizing, booking, paying, documenting and reimbursing business travel and related expenses in India and for international business trips originating in India.

Business travel must be necessary, reasonable, economical and connected to an approved business purpose. Limits are ceilings, not spending targets.

Where this policy refers to an approved channel, supplier, rate card, employee grade or approval authority, the production organization must populate those values from its current controlled source.

Definitions

Business trip means approved travel away from the employee's normal work location for company business. Domestic travel means travel within India; international travel means travel crossing an international border.

Per diem means a fixed daily allowance where the applicable rate card permits fixed-rate reimbursement instead of actual documented meals.

Personal expense means a cost primarily for personal convenience, leisure or private travel and is not reimbursable unless expressly allowed.

Core controls

Employees must not split, duplicate or deliberately misclassify expenses to avoid a limit or approval requirement.

An approved expense must still satisfy the applicable policy rule. Manager approval does not convert a prohibited expense into an eligible expense.

Questions requiring live information such as airline schedules, current exchange rates or current tax law should be answered using the relevant live system rather than a static policy.

6. Meals, Food & Business Entertainment

Meals

Reasonable meals during approved travel are reimbursable subject to the applicable meal or daily limit.

Breakfast, lunch and dinner eligibility depends on travel timing and the applicable rate card. Meals during normal office attendance are not reimbursable unless part of an approved business event.

When per diem is used, the same meal must not also be claimed as an actual expense.

Client meals

Client meals require a genuine business purpose and should record the date, supplier, amount and participants or customer relationship where required.

Above-limit meals or meals involving external guests may require additional approval.

Alcohol is not reimbursable as a personal meal expense. Any business entertainment involving alcohol must comply with the separate entertainment and compliance rules.

Entertainment

Business entertainment must be modest, reasonable, lawful and connected to a genuine business purpose. Personal social events and leisure entertainment are excluded.